

Resume & Networking Workshops

Resume

Session #3 - Reading Job Descriptions for Resume Edits

- Look for repeated words in a target job description and try to repeat those in your resume bullets
 - “Creativity” = highlight thinking outside the box
 - “Monetization” = what did you monetize
 - “Cross-functional leadership” = working with multiple teams simultaneously
 - Particularly, if they tell you who their customers are, and you have experience working with these stakeholders, highlight this
- If the posting says “The successful candidate must commit to XYZ dates,” be ready to commit to these. Don’t ask for an exception
- Really long phrases (bullets that are extra long or at a greater level of detail than the others) suggest this is a pain point in the company; network to confirm this is the case and emphasize the skills that can “fix” or combat this
- Most job descriptions are templates that hiring managers then tweak for the most important aspects of the role. If there is a phrase that is atypical, it means it was intentionally changed
- Networking question idea: What are the traits of the most successful person?

Session #2 - Resume Format

- Formatting varies for the intended next move. The goal is readability because recruiters spend 7-8 seconds per resume, so your goal is marketing
 - Chronological: 1) “Classic/traditional” industries like banking, consulting, etc. 2) Single pivot (same role, new industry or new industry, same role)
 - Hybrid:
 - Definition: Job titles all in a row under the company name. Then sections of bullets fall under function or skill—“Cross-functional leadership,” “Analytical problem solving,” “Organizational strategy and influence,” etc.
 - Ensure your categories are your strengths
 - Functional (most rare): 1) Big pivots 2) Unfamiliar industries (e.g. teaching) 3) Transferable skills 4) Whole career has been in one industry and jobs are so similar
- If you are pivoting, the first question you will get in an interview is why the change. If there is doubt about your skills, network to have an internal advocate convince internally that you can do the role
- If you worked at a niche company (or one that would not be widely known) pick attributes that would be appealing to your target audience—revenue, number of countries,

examples of customers/big brands, “the biggest [industry] company and first tech unicorn”

- There are attributes you can use to connect with new companies when making a pivot—rapid growth in your resume, similar customer bases (size, region, industry), B2B vs B2C
- Applicant tracking system (ATS)
 - ATS systems neither accept nor reject your resume; it indexes them to make it easier for the recruiter to read your resume. Haas’ standard format makes this easier by design
 - Recruiters don’t put any value in algorithm-generated resume “rating.” They rely on 8-second personal, “human” scan
- Remove undergrad GPA because the moment it’s added it opens you up to comparison
- Remove undergrad awards unless you have space
- Make sure you have an additional section and be humorous to entice the reader to ask you about it. The section should be 1-3 lines
 - Example: Interests: Amateur backyard farmer, optimistic AI futurist, and washed-up distance runner (former D1 athlete.)

Skill Headings for MBA Resumes

Leadership Leadership and Business Development Leadership and Key Accomplishments Leadership and Communications Collaborative Leadership Business Leadership Partnership and Leadership Development Leadership and Operations Leadership & Organizational Impact Leadership / Influence Leadership & Strategy Strategy Strategic Planning Strategic Marketing Strategy & Analysis Strategy & Process Improvement Organizational Strategy Strategic Thinking Strategic Business Planning Business Strategy Planning and Strategy Organization/Implementation Project Management & Execution Project Execution & Delivery Project Management Analysis and Organization Project & People Management Relationship/Communication Communication Skills Cross-functional Teamwork Cross-functional Team Leadership Communication & Relationship Building Communication & Strategy Persuasion & Influence Customer Focus Client Service Influence Without Authority Relationship Management Client Relations Interpersonal Skills Change Management Organizational Transformation Business Infrastructure and Development Expertise Health IT Industry Expertise Tech Systems Implementation & Optimization Process Improvement Operational Excellence Contracts & Negotiations	Analysis Analysis & Problem Solving Analytical Problem Solving Problem Solving & Innovation Analytics Quantitative and Qualitative Analysis Financial Analysis and Valuation Research and Analysis Problem Solving Critical Analysis & Problem Solving Creative Problem Solving Market Analysis Skills Analytical Capabilities Data Driven Decision Making Research or Research & Development Financial Modeling Quantitative & Analytical Analysis and Market Research Creative Innovation and Strategy Program Development & Design Product Design and Development Product Development Creativity & Communication Innovation Leadership Process Innovation Thought Leadership & Creativity Creativity & Teamwork Marketing Marketing & Business Development Marketing Communications Marketing & Strategic Planning Marketing & Communication Skills Consumer Insight and Analytical Skills Sales & Business Development Marketing & Strategy Market Research & Competitive Analysis Sales & Marketing International Sales and Marketing Sales & Customer Focus Business Functions Finance Operations New Product Development Sales / Sales Management Marketing Engineering Other – Be Creative Results Orientation, Initiative & Problem Solving
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Session #1 - Resume Bullets

- Resume bullets should include 3/4 elements at a minimum
 - What: The thing, or “work object,” you made

- How: What skills you used to make that work object (skills should be tailored to the employer/role)
 - Impact: Measurable outcome ideally
 - Why: Why was it important, was it part of a company's bigger strategy? How often did you do it, etc.
- Start with "impact" if it is large; start with "how" if you are pivoting industry, or potentially role, where the vocabulary is not the same
- All bullets should be explicit rather than intentionally mysterious to generate curiosity or a follow-up question
- Adjectives and adverbs is what makes a bullet long
- Use abbreviations *only* if you are moving within the same industry or function
- Gen AI use cases
 - Rewrite your bullets
 - Point out what's moving
 - Improve readability
- Gen AI quality controls—is everything true, check for too much jargon (including adjectives and adverbs), 3-letter acronyms, read it outloud, and ensure the bullets include the three elements (what, how, why)
- If you don't know what the impact for a bullet is (this happens often in consulting), put down what the projected impact would be

WHAT	• <u>Developed financial models and scenarios for opening retail stores.</u>
WHAT HOW	• Developed financial models and scenarios for opening retail stores <u>by analyzing local demographics and transportation patterns.</u>
WHAT HOW WHY	• Developed financial models and scenarios for opening stores by analyzing local demographics and transportation patterns <u>for the company's first foray into retail.</u>
WHAT HOW IMPACT	• Adjusted financial models and scenarios for retail locations by analyzing local demographics and transportation patterns, <u>resulting in +25% sales/sqft than projected.</u>

Shifting the Emphasis of your Bullets

What + How + Why + Impact

- Created a GTM plan by analyzing demographic data and traffic patterns as part of a new feature rollout resulting in a 35% conversion rate at launch

Impact + How + What + Why

- Generated a 35% conversion rate at launch by analyzing demographic data and traffic patterns in the GTM plan for a new feature rollout.

Process to Advance Your Career

- Six steps of a successful job search
 - 0) Clarity on your “way” and your interests
 - 1) Desk research
 - This can be 20 minutes. It does not have to be exhaustive
 - 2) Value proposition development
 - This combines desk research and how you can help. You position yourself as being able to contribute to an initiative or solve a problem. What do you bring to the table that is interesting to that company?
 - 3) Low-to-medium stakes pressure test and feedback
 - Low-stakes: CMG, Haas undergrad (first-years, second-years, and EWMBA), peer advisors, faculty
 - Medium-stakes: Case competition, Haas networking events, alumni
 - 4) Revise and refine
 - 5) High stakes pressure test and feedback
 - High stakes: Application or interview
 - Long before you get to this stage, you should iterate earlier; learn what questions or challenges to anticipate, gaps in your company knowledge, etc.
 - Feedback in high stakes testing can be limited; whether you are declined, and at what stage, is feedback
 - 6) Revise and refine
- As you move down the funnel your personal value prop and target network gets more specific
- Most common step missed is step #1; if you skip it, every subsequent step in the process suffers
- Desk research
 - Your why: Personal and resonates with you
 - Interests and preferences: Interesting or matters to you (e.g. sector, company size geography, roles, functions, remove/hybrids, values)
 - Domain knowledge interests: Specific (beyond popular knowledge) *and* interesting to you, strategic/operational priorities/challenges of the organization
 - Resources for desk research: WSJ, Forbes, annual reports (especially footnotes,) financial times, Youtube, listen to quarterly earnings review with the analysts (particularly the questions to understand where they are growing)
- Developing value proposition
 - Resume, refining response to “tell me about yourself,” transferable skills, and career conversations (networking)
 - Career conversations comes down to the quality of questions that you ask, which is dependent on your desk research
- Prioritizing: Making consistent choices that advance you towards your highest goal
 - You have 18 hours per week to manage, and in order to prioritize you have to make hard decisions that makes someone (including yourself) unhappy

- You sometimes have to “disappoint” yourself in order to achieve your long-term goals
- Do what you need to do, not what others can afford to do

Networking for Success

- Recommended read: *The Two Hour Job Search*
- Process for networking:
 - 1) Generate a hypothesis to explore—industry, function, location, etc.
 - 2) Generate learning targets—40-50 target companies and look at their earnings, strategy, etc.
 - 3) Begin your networking list—people from undergrad and grad who work there
 - 4) Plan first outreach
- Benefits of networking—refine target industry and roles, learn the vocabulary, identify hidden opportunities (60% of jobs are not posted,) practice and refine your personal pitch, and build relationships
 - The further you are in your career, or after your MBA graduation date, the more likely your next job is going to come from your network
- Referrals
 - Referrals come after you build the trusting relationship; start with a networking call, keep in touch with them, and then ask for the referral; never ask for a referral in the first call
 - Getting a referral from someone in another city/office can be valuable, but it depends on the company, city, culture, etc
 - Wait until after the first conversation to ask who else to whom else to talk; the first networking call is all about the other person—your curiosity in what they do or how they do it
- Exploratory conversations
 - Start networking only but *only after* desk research about the person, company, etc.
- Developing company and industry focus list
 - If you say “tech,” what type of tech? If you say “fintech” what type of fintech? Start with dream employers
 - If you aren’t sure where to start for your target list of companies, look at conferences of interest and make a list of companies attending and sponsors
 - The CMG (Haas Career Management Group) has seen success with student cold-calling dream companies. It requires more desk work and more guts
- If you are apprehensive about not being “ready” before an exploratory conversation, be upfront about this and impress them with your preparation and questions. Don’t let the feeling of “not be ready” prevent you from having a call
- Outreach principles
 - 1) Short (<100 words)
 - Only ask for 15-20 minutes
 - 2) No mention of you looking for or asking for jobs/internships

- 3) State your connection up front
 - “Ex-Fintech to Fintech” or “From Haasie to Haasie” subject line
 - 4) Generalize interest in industry/role
 - 5) It’s about them
- Follow-up
 - 1) Thank you note
 - 2) Keep them in the loop, or the “post card” strategy—where you traveled to and that you’re thinking of them
 - Another way to keep in touch is notifying them of milestones—finishing the semester, coming back from a trip, etc. For example, “I just came back from winter break. I’ve talked to more companies and remain really interested. I found XYZ interesting. If more happens, I’ll let you know. Let me know if you’re in the area, and it would be great to meet for coffee”
- Goal: 2 outreaches per week